

TRAIL RESOURCE CONDITION ASSESSMENT GUIDE

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Issued by: Glacier National Park Resource Management - Personal Reference Copy

Prepared for: Field Staff Personal Use

PURPOSE

This guide provides condition codes and recommended management responses for trail surface and corridor assessments conducted during personal field surveys. Use this guide together with field notes to assign the correct condition classification for each surveyed trail segment.

CONDITION CODE REFERENCE TABLE

CODE 1 - STABLE

Visual indicators: Trail surface intact with no visible erosion. Tread firm and compacted. No ruts or root exposure observed.

Recommended action: No action required. Continue routine monitoring.

CODE 2 - MINOR WEAR

Visual indicators: Surface scuffing, minor tread widening, or shallow ruts less than 5 cm deep. No active water movement. Tread remains functional.

Recommended action: Note for monitoring at next survey interval. Consider seasonal improvements if wear persists.

CODE 3 - MODERATE EROSION

Visual indicators: Ruts between 5 and 12 cm deep, exposed roots or rocks, or early cross-trail drainage developing. Tread degrading but passable.

Recommended action: Schedule maintenance before next survey season. Document in field notes. Flag segment for work crew review.

CODE 4 - ACTIVE EROSION

Visual indicators: Ruts deeper than 12 cm, significant root undercutting, or active water channeling across the tread surface. Condition is worsening.

Recommended action: Restrict segment to foot traffic pending maintenance. Document thoroughly. Schedule maintenance work order within the current field season.

CODE 5 - SEVERE DAMAGE

Visual indicators: Trail tread impassable or presenting immediate visitor safety hazard. Slope failure, major trail loss, or structural failure of drainage features present.

Recommended action: Close trail segment. Notify supervisor immediately. Contact area resource management for emergency assessment and response.

ESCALATION THRESHOLD

Condition code 5 (Severe Damage) requires immediate supervisor notification. For all other codes, document findings in field notes and route to area

supervisor during the standard seasonal reporting cycle.

FIELD DOCUMENTATION GUIDELINES

For each surveyed segment, record the following in your field notes:

- Segment identifier
- Assigned condition code from this guide
- Recommended action
- Assessor initials
- Survey date
- Standards version used (record "v1.9" for this edition)

VERSION HISTORY

v1.9 (current) - January 10, 2024: Code 4 description updated with active water channeling language. Code 3 rut depth threshold revised.

v1.8 - March 2023: Minor formatting revisions. No content changes.

v1.7 - September 2022: Code 5 escalation language strengthened.

END OF DOCUMENT
